

MATERIAL STUDY

The living thing, kept

Autumn is the only season whose botanical is meant to be dried — and there is a deep rightness to it. Where summer's fresh stem celebrates the moment, the dried plume honours the turn: a grass at the exact point it has gone from green to gold, preserved there. Pampas, wheat, seed heads, branches of turned leaves — they hold the season's colour through the dark months and ask for nothing, no water, no tending. It is the most literal *mono no aware* a room can hold: a plant kept beautiful precisely because it has stopped growing.

"A dried stem is a season you decided to keep."

